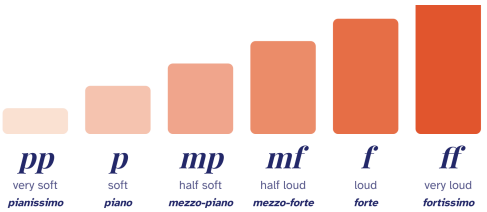
EXPRESSION · LOUD AND SOFT · LEARN

# Loud and soft




**REMEMBER** pp p mp mf f ff: from a whisper to a shout. **m** (mezzo) means half; a second letter means very.

## 1 Say it

★☆☆

Write the Italian name and what it means. The first row is done.

| SIGN | NAME | MEANS |
|---|---|---|
| *p* | piano | soft |
| *mf* | | |
| *ff* | | |
| *mp* | | |
| *pp* | | |
| *f* | | |

## 2 Soft to loud

★☆☆

Write these six signs in order, from the softest to the loudest: *mf* *pp* *f* *p* *ff* *mp*. The first is done.

pp ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

## 3 Louder or softer?

★☆☆

Does the music get louder or softer from the first sign to the second? The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **mp → mf** | **louder** · softer |
| **f → p** | louder · softer |
| **pp → mp** | louder · softer |
| **ff → mf** | louder · softer |
| **p → f** | louder · softer |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Play Middle C six times: pp, p, mp, mf, f, ff. Six different steps? Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____
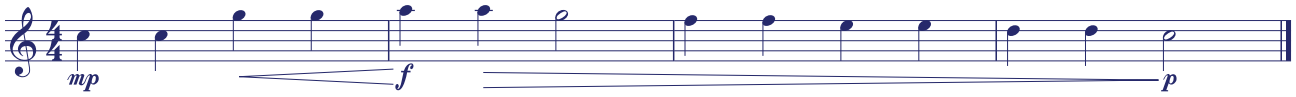
EXPRESSION · LOUD AND SOFT · USE

# Loud and soft

**REMEMBER** A hairpin that opens grows louder (cresc.); one that closes fades (dim.).

## 1 Read the hairpins ★★☆

Look at the music and complete each sentence. The first is done.




It starts [ mp ] (sign).

The loudest note is in bar [ ] , marked [ ] .

It ends [ ] (sign).

## 2 Signs and words ★☆☆

Write what each one asks you to do. The first is done.

| SIGN | WHAT YOU DO |
|---|---|
| *cresc.* | getting louder, little by little |
| *dim.* | |
| ***sfz*** | |
| ***fp*** | |
| *subito p* | |

## 3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| mf is louder than mp. | T F |
| A crescendo also gets faster. | T F |
| A dynamic lasts until the next one. | T F |
| sfz makes one note suddenly strong. | T F |

## 4 Play it ★☆☆

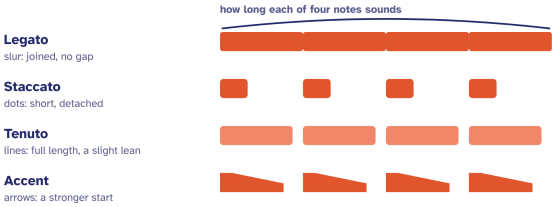
Play C D E F G growing from p to f, then come down fading to p, without speeding up. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · TOUCH · LEARN

# Touch: smooth, short, strong




**REMEMBER** Curve: join. Dot: short. Line: hold. Arrow: strong.

## 1 Name the mark

★☆☆

Write the name and how to play it. The first row is done.

| MARK | NAME | HOW |
|---|---|---|
| a dot | staccato | short, let go early |
| a curve over different notes | | |
| a line | | |
| > (an arrow) | | |
| a wedge ▼ | | |

## 2 Which notes are short?

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.



Bar 1 is played [joined] (joined or short).

In bar 2, [ ] notes have dots.

The last G has an [ ] .

## 3 Slur or tie?

★☆☆

Circle slur or tie. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **a curve over C D E** | (slur) · tie |
| **a curve joining G and G** | slur · tie |
| **a curve over E F** | slur · tie |
| **a curve joining two Bs** | slur · tie |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Hot Cross Buns: play E D C joined, then short and bouncy. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · TOUCH · USE

# Touch: smooth, short, strong

**REMEMBER** A two-note slur: drop into the first note, lift off the second.

## 1 Mood words ★☆☆

Write what each word means. The first is done.

| WORD | MEANING |
|---|---|
| *dolce* | **sweetly** |
| *cantabile* | |
| *leggiero* | |
| *espressivo* | |
| *maestoso* | |

## 2 Touch for the job ★★☆

Circle the touch that fits best. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **a lullaby** | **legato** · staccato · accent |
| **a bouncing ball** | legato · staccato · accent |
| **a march, with strong beats** | legato · staccato · accent |
| **a singing tune** | legato · staccato · accent |

## 3 Drop and lift ★☆☆

Each pair has a two-note slur. Write drop or lift under each note. The first is done.

| PAIR | NOTE 1 | NOTE 2 |
|---|---|---|
| E–D | **drop** | **lift** |
| G–F | | |
| C–B | | |

## 4 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Staccato means loud. | T F |
| A tenuto note is held its full length. | T F |
| Lift your hand at the end of a slur. | T F |

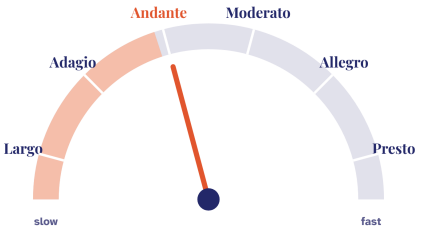
## 5 Play it ★☆☆

Play one bar of a piece three ways: all legato, all staccato, then as written. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · SPEED WORDS · LEARN




# Speed words

**REMEMBER** Largo, Adagio, Andante, Moderato, Allegro, Presto: slow to fast. ♩ = 60 is one beat a second.

## 1 Slow to fast ★☆☆

Write these words in order, from the slowest to the fastest: Allegro, Largo, Andante, Presto, Adagio, Moderato. The first is done.

Largo _____ _____ _____ _____ _____

## 2 What does it mean? ★☆☆

Write the meaning. The first is done.

| WORD | MEANING |
|---|---|
| **Andante** | at a walking pace |
| **Allegro** | |
| **Adagio** | |
| **Presto** | |
| **Moderato** | |
| **Lento** | |

## 3 Metronome maths ★★☆

Complete each sentence. The first is done.

At ♩ = 60 there is one beat every [ 1 ] second(s).

At ♩ = 120 there are [ ] beats every second.

At ♩ = 30 there is one beat every [ ] seconds.

## 4 Play it ★☆☆

Walk at Andante saying 1 2 3 4, then jog at Allegro. Then clap both. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · SPEED WORDS · USE

# Speed words

**REMEMBER** rit. and rall.: gradually slower. accel.: gradually faster. a tempo: back to the first speed.

## 1 Changing speed
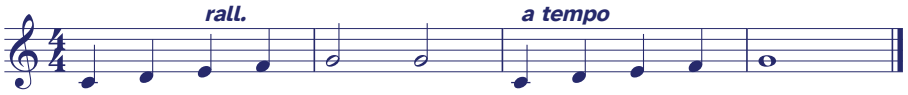
★☆☆

Write what each one asks. The first is done.

| WORD OR SIGN | WHAT YOU DO |
|---|---|
| *rit.* | **gradually slower** |
| *accel.* | |
| *a tempo* | |
| *rall.* | |
| *poco a poco* | |
| *più mosso* | |
| fermata (pause) | |

## 2 Read the map

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.




The music slows down in bar [ 1 ] .

The first speed comes back in bar [ ] , at the words _____ .

## 3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Andante is very slow. | T F |
| A fermata means hold the note longer. | T F |
| meno mosso means faster. | T F |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

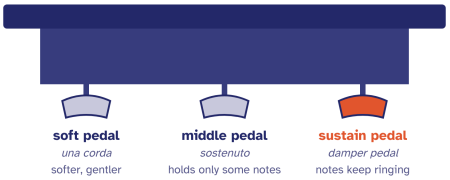
Play C D E F G and slow down into the G (rit.), then play it again a tempo. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · THE PEDALS · LEARN

# The pedals




**REMEMBER** Ped.: right pedal down. ✻: up. Play first, then pedal.

## 1 Which pedal?
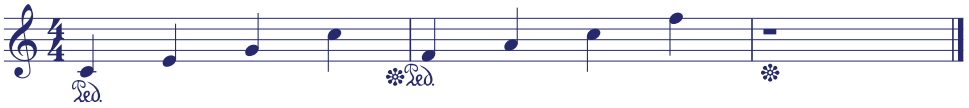
★☆☆

Write which pedal and what your foot does. The first row is done.

| SIGN | PEDAL | FOOT |
|---|---|---|
| **Ped.** | **right** | **down** |
| ✻ | | |
| **u.c.** | | |
| **t.c.** | | |

## 2 Read the pedal

★★☆

Look at the music and complete the sentences. The first is done.




The pedal goes down on the first [ C ] .

It changes on the first note of bar [ ] .

It comes up in bar [ ] .

## 3 Play first, then pedal

★★☆

Number the steps of a pedal change in order. The first is done.

| STEP | ORDER |
|---|---|
| play the new notes | 1 |
| press the pedal down again | |
| lift the pedal | |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C E G together, press the pedal, take your hands off and listen. Lift the pedal. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · THE PEDALS · USE

# The pedals

**REMEMBER** A new chord, a new pedal: play it, then change straight away.

## 1 Clean or muddy?

★★☆

Circle what you will hear. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **a change after every new chord** | **clean** · muddy · a gap |
| **the pedal held from C-E-G into F-A-C** | clean · muddy · a gap |
| **the pedal lifted before the new notes** | clean · muddy · a gap |
| **a change just after the new notes** | clean · muddy · a gap |

## 2 Where do you change?

★★☆

Each bar has one group of notes. Write down, change or none for each bar. The first is done.

| BAR | PEDAL |
|---|---|
| bar 1: C E G | down |
| bar 2: C E G again | |
| bar 3: F A C | |
| bar 4: G B D | |
| bar 5: G B D again | |

## 3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| Keep your heel on the floor. | T F |
| u.c. is the right pedal. | T F |
| Change the pedal at the same moment as the new chord. | T F |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C-E-G, F-A-C, G-B-D, C-E-G slowly with a change on each. Tick a circle each clean day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · ORNAMENTS · LEARN

# Ornaments

**REMEMBER** An ornament borrows the next-door notes: one letter up or one letter down.

## 1 Name the ornament

★☆☆

Write the name of each one. The first is done.

| SIGN | NAME |
|---|---|
| tr | trill |
| a zigzag | |
| a zigzag with a line through it | |
| a lying-down S (~) | |
| a tiny note with a slash | |
| a tiny note without a slash | |

## 2 Next-door notes

★☆☆

Write the letter above and the letter below. The first row is done.

| MAIN NOTE | ABOVE | BELOW |
|---|---|---|
| D | E | C |
| G | | |
| A | | |
| F | | |
| B | | |

## 3 Spell it out

★★☆

Write the notes you play. The first is done.

| ORNAMENT | NOTES |
|---|---|
| upper mordent on G | G A G |
| lower mordent on A | |
| turn on D | |
| trill on E (four notes) | |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Play D and E with fingers 2 and 3, slowly, eight times, then a little faster. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Date _____

EXPRESSION · ORNAMENTS · USE

# Ornaments

**REMEMBER** Slash: crushed in (acciaccatura). No slash: leans, taking half the time (appoggiatura).

## 1 Crushed or leaning?

★★☆

Circle the name. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **a tiny note with a slash** | **acciaccatura** · appoggiatura |
| **a tiny note without a slash** | acciaccatura · appoggiatura |
| **played as fast as possible** | acciaccatura · appoggiatura |
| **takes half the main note's time** | acciaccatura · appoggiatura |

## 2 Above or below?

★☆☆

Which next-door note does each use? Circle one. The first is done.

| | |
|---|---|
| **trill** | **above** · below · both |
| **upper mordent** | above · below · both |
| **lower mordent** | above · below · both |
| **turn** | above · below · both |

## 3 True or false?

★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| An ornament starts on the beat. | T F |
| A trill uses the note below. | T F |
| The main note still lands on time. | T F |

## 4 Play it

★☆☆

Play C D E F G with an upper mordent on each note, slowly. Tick a circle each day.

○ ○ ○ ○ ○

## 5 Explain it

★★☆

In your own words: how do you play an upper mordent on D, and where does it start?

Date _____

EXPRESSION · REVIEW

# Review

TEN MINUTES No help, no piano. Mark it with the answers on page 13.

## 1 Name them ★☆☆

Write what each one means.

| | |
|---|---|
| *mp* | |
| *rit.* | |
| **Ped.** | |
| a dot over a note | |

## 2 Complete it ★★☆

One word in each space.

Andante means at a ☐ pace.

A curve over different notes is a ☐ .

A trill goes back and forth with the note ☐ .

## 3 True or false? ★☆☆

Circle T or F.

| | |
|---|---|
| ff is softer than f. | T F |
| a tempo means back to the first speed. | T F |
| Change the pedal before you play the new chord. | T F |

Score ☐ / 10

Date _____

EXPRESSION · PROGRESS

# My progress

**HOW TO USE** Tick each column when it is true. Come back to this page every few weeks.

| CONCEPT | I KNOW IT | I CAN WRITE IT | I CAN PLAY IT | HANDBOOK |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| dynamics: pp to ff | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 76 |
| crescendo and diminuendo | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 76 |
| slurs, staccato, tenuto, accents | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 79 |
| mood words | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 79 |
| tempo words and the metronome | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 82 |
| rit., accel., a tempo, fermata | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 82 |
| the sustain pedal | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 85 |
| ornaments | ☐ | ☐ | ☐ | p. 88 |

**Teacher's note**

Date _____

EXPRESSION · ANSWERS

# Answers

| PAGE | ANSWERS |
|---|---|
| p. 1 | Say it: mf mezzo-forte half loud · ff fortissimo very loud · mp mezzo-piano half soft · pp pianissimo very soft · f forte loud. Order: pp p mp mf f ff. Louder/softer: louder, softer, louder, softer, louder. |
| p. 2 | Hairpins: mp; bar 2, f; p. Signs: dim. getting softer · sfz one note suddenly strong · fp loud, then soft at once · subito p suddenly soft. T/F: T, F, T, T. |
| p. 3 | Marks: slur, join smoothly · tenuto, hold full length · accent, a stronger start · staccatissimo, very short. Short notes: joined; two; accent. Slur or tie: slur, tie, slur, tie. |
| p. 4 | Mood words: in a singing style · lightly · with feeling · majestically. Touch: legato, staccato, accent, legato. Drop and lift: drop, lift (every pair). T/F: F, T, T. |
| p. 5 | Order: Largo, Adagio, Andante, Moderato, Allegro, Presto. Meanings: fast and lively · slow, at ease · very fast · moderate · slow. Metronome: 1; 2; 2. |
| p. 6 | Changing speed: gradually faster · back to the speed before · gradually slower · little by little · more movement, faster · hold longer than written. Map: bar 1; bar 3, a tempo. T/F: F, T, F. |
| p. 7 | Pedals: right, up · left, down · left, up. Read the pedal: C; bar 2; bar 3. Order: play 1, lift 2, press down again 3. |
| p. 8 | Clean or muddy: clean, muddy, a gap, clean. Where: none, change, change, none. T/F: T, F, F. |
| p. 9 | Names: upper mordent, lower mordent, turn, acciaccatura, appoggiatura. Next door: G A F · A B G · F G E · B C A. Spell: A G A · E D C D · E F E F. |
| p. 10 | Crushed or leaning: acciaccatura, appoggiatura, acciaccatura, appoggiatura. Above or below: above, above, below, both. T/F: T, F, T. |
| p. 11 | half soft · gradually slower · right pedal down · short (staccato). walking; slur; above. F, T, F. |

“Play it”, “in your music”, listening and playing have no single answer to copy: check them at the piano with your teacher, or with the online lessons.

Date _____